

wireless peripherals to mobile devices. This includes items such as keyboards or headsets. This technology can also be used for networking between devices and sharing an internet connection (commonly known as tethering). Tethering is a method of connecting a mobile device such as a



A Bluetooth USB dongle

laptop, netbook or tablet with a mobile phone or any other mobile device to share the wireless broadband connection. So you can share your internet connection on your phone with your tablet via Bluetooth. We'll learn how to tether different gadgets in the later chapters.

Wireless Base Station

An emerging form of wireless connectivity is Wireless Base Station. It allows an individual to connect a wireless router to a high-speed wireless network such as a 3G network, allowing other devices that have standard Wi-Fi to share that broadband connection. You just have to turn on the device and it connects to your network provider and creates a portable Wi-Fi hotspot to which several devices can be connected. Tata Indicom and MTS currently provide this service in India and charge you around ₹5,000 for the base unit and monthly charges depending on your data plan. However if you use these, you can't switch your network provider. To have this freedom you need to get a Dlink DIR-457 pocket router. With this you can choose your own network provider, your data plan and switch network providers just by swapping the SIM card in it. You'll learn how to use this pocket router in the later chapters.

NAS boxes

Network Attached Storage (NAS) is a dedicated data storage technology, which can be connected directly to a computer-network in order to provide a centralised data-access and storage to all compatible network-clients. In short a NAS is a standalone file-level computer data storage device, into which you can install one or more internal or external hard disk drives, and then connect the NAS device directly to your network.

The NAS device is given its own IP address. This allows you to configure it to share the hard drives and their data contents on the network to other